

Support to Study

Stage Two – Minutes and Support / Action Plan

Date: Tuesday 3 rd March 2026	Support to Study Meeting Stage (e.g. Stage 2 Meeting): Stage 2
Student Name: Harry Wright	Student ID: N0605150
Course Title & Year of Study: MSc Smart Agriculture PT year 2	Level (UG, PG, PGR) & Mode of Study (FT, PT, DL): PG, part-time
Further detail relating to study if applicable (e.g. Repeat Year, Final Attempt, NECs, etc): n/a	
Disability / Long term health condition disclosed to the University?	Yes
Access Statement in place?	Yes
Support to Study Lead: Steven Godby	
In attendance: (include name, role and department of additional colleagues present, and any persons accompanying the student – if applicable): Angelo Pernetta (Deputy Dean, Chair) Steven Godby (Principal Lecturer, Presenting Officer) Nadine Gilbert (Student Support Services Representative) Kevin Bowers (Subject Coordinator, Minutes)	

Notes from the discussions

1.	Context setting / reasons for Stage Two Meeting
	At the start of the meeting It was noted that Harry was not in attendance, and the meeting would be conducted without his presence. Harry had actively responded to the invitations to the meeting, making clear he would not be attending and the reasons why. All attendees agreed to check on the Microsoft Teams invitation periodically, in case Harry opted to attend remotely after the start time. For context, Harry is studying the part-time offering of MSc Smart Agriculture and is midway through the second and final year of study. The meeting has been escalated to Stage 2, bypassing Stage 1, due to the nature of the concerns. The specific concerns due to be discussed, as outlined in the invitation letter, are: - The nature and content of an email with the subject “URGENT: SIG-02 Ledger // OIA/1639159/26 // SAR Receipt & Meeting Notice” sent on 23 January 2026 to several recipients, including the Head of Department and Associate Dean for Research. - Requests to study an alternative module to ARES40380 Sustainability in the Food Supply Chain and for a change in the supervisor allocated to you for ARES40061 MSc Research Project.

	• Refusal to engage with a meeting to discuss your research project and supervision. • Attendance patterns in the module ARES40380 Sustainability in the Food Supply Chain. • The phrasing of other emails sent to NTU staff and mailboxes. These concerns represent a suspected downturn in Harry's well-being, which mostly began after an upheld Student Code of Behaviour (SCoB) against Harry in December. Escalation directly to Stage 2 was recommended because of attendance, content and writing style of emails (to academic and admin staff) and outstanding credit balance. We have concerns about Harry's health and wellbeing, with several staff having recommended a referral. The nature of the email responses goes beyond the School, with concerning contact being made with the governance team and external organisations, having an impact on the wider University. Furthermore, Harry is paying full fees and doesn't appear to be engaging with elements of his studies, with limited attendance in one module and no interaction or apparent progress in his Research Project.
2.	Overview of discussion points covered during the meeting Timeline As a background to these concerns, Harry has been involved in 2 SCoB investigations in the past 18 months. The first was an investigation involving Harry and the former MSc Smart Agriculture course leader, Bahar Aciksoz, with some evidence also supplied by Harry's peers from the 2024/25 cohort. The school were not informed of the outcome of this investigation. While pursuing the outcome of this meeting in October 2025, SG was informed by the investigating officer that there is no obligation to inform course teams. Shortly after this contact, the course team were made aware of a SCoB investigation relating to a situation between Harry and a member of staff. This SCoB investigation was upheld, with a 6 month notice to Harry's record which also required him to avoid interacting with the member of staff. Harry appealed this outcome, and after the appeal was rejected appears to be pursuing other means of having this overturned. Most notably these means are via the OIA, which he has directly referenced, and also contacting other departments within the University about this. Shortly after the SCoB appeal outcome, Harry contacted the School Admin team and the Higher Education Head of Department (HoD) to request a module change. In these messages Harry requested to replace the Sustainability in the Food Chain module with one of the GIS modules from our MSc Applied Ecology course. These requests were rebuffed as MSc Smart Agriculture has a fixed module provision and there is no means for a student to mix and match modules from other courses. Around this time Harry also requested a change of Research Supervisor away from Mark Oxenbury, who is also Harry's Course Leader and Research Project Supervisor. No reason was given for this request, and as there is no provision for changing Research Tutors outside of exceptional circumstances, the request was rejected. Following these requests, SG arranged a meeting to speak with Harry about the requests and understand the reasons for the module and supervisor change requests. Harry refused to attend the meeting, and one of his follow up messages to this request was the aforementioned email with the subject "URGENT: SIG-02 Ledger // OIA/1639159/26 // SAR Receipt & Meeting Notice". This caused concern, as the tone and terminology used throughout the email and document were unorthodox. An example of this being the term "crossing the ghost fence", which was used in the document. Harry shared this email with several NTU staff, including SG, ARES HoD Beverley Peel, a Brackenhurst Car Park Officer, a

Data Protection Officer and the ARES Associate Dean for Research. The ARES HoD contacted Alex Gooderham, Student Conduct Officer, after we received this for further context, as it was too early for a response from the OIA. Alex suggested Support to Study at this stage and an SSS referral.

Nadine Gilbert received the SSS referral, and contacted Harry in late January leaving a voicemail and sending an email to him. Harry hasn't responded to these requests to date. Nadine has also been copied into various emails concerning Harry over the past 6 months, including those related to this meeting. Nadine has previously contacted Harry regarding a CSID report, which is unrelated to the scenarios noted above. On 3/11/2025 Harry made a self-referral, meeting with Nadine on 1/12/2025 to discuss support related to the SCoB. Nadine was present for the SCoB meeting in December and copied into the outcome emails. Harry did not respond to Nadine's offers of a meeting afterward. Nadine sent a follow up email to Harry on 8/1/2026, after Harry had sent 2 emails to admin mailbox asking about changing modules to take GIS. Harry's only contact with Nadine since the SCoB meeting has been to request advice on how to change his dissertation supervisor.

A concern arising from this timeline is that Harry is rejecting contact from any staff who were either involved in the SCoB, or who have been copied into outcome emails related to the SCoB, though this is speculation.

Academic Progress and Engagement

Harry has 100 credits to complete this year, and having completed his Research Methods module has 80 credits outstanding; these are the modules Sustainability in the Food Chain (20 credits) and the MSc Research Project (60 credits). The Research Methods assessment has not been formally verified by an exam board yet, with the next meeting of the board being in June.

Harry's current attendance for 'Sustainability in the Food Chain' is 20%. He has submitted a formative assessment for this module, though concerns have been raised on the terminology and phrasing in the formative. Unusual language has been used throughout, such as tomatoes being weaponised by corporations.

We currently have no understanding of Harry's progress on his Research Project. To our knowledge, he has not completed his ethics form nor agreed on the questions or topic of his project*. Mark Oxenbury had suggested some questions, including a meeting with an external business, during a meeting on 24/10/2025, which is noted on Dashboard. The only recent contact we are aware of between Mark and Harry was a few weeks ago, where they bumped into each other outside the library, and Harry had stated he wanted to change research supervisor as he didn't trust Mark.

**Post meeting note: After the meeting we saw that Harry had submitted an unsigned ethics form to the DropBox on 11/12/2025. Harry left a comment saying he had asked Mark to sign it, however it is unclear whether Mark and Harry had met prior to the submission.*

Harry does have an Access Statement, which references mental health and autism. The access statement hasn't been used to date for extension requests through the NEC policy (2024/25) or CPC policy (2025/26).

It's noted that Harry has received solid grades in the summative assessments he has submitted so far.

Harry's last attendance was 03/02/2026, a Research Project session. Before that 02/02/2026 and 26/01/2026. Harry attended the first session with Hannah Ronan-Brown

	and left halfway through. He hasn't attended sessions led by Andy Gill, Hanah Ronan-Brown or Adam Bates, but did attend Julia Davies' class. Harry has accessed some NOW learning rooms, though his interaction score is considerably lower than the cohort average. Harry's card swipes are close to the cohort average, though it isn't clear if this is at Brackenhurst or other campuses.
3.	Agreed outcomes following Stage Two Meeting The ideal outcome would have been a discussion with Harry to establish: • Why he is unhappy with his research project supervisor. • What he has in mind for his research project. • Reasons for low attendance. • Why the focus on GIS as an alternate module. The conversation could have explored these issues and led to a roadmap for overcoming them. Another concern raised is what appears from the outside to be a decision to place his studies on pause, with little engagement with his modules. While Harry has submitted a formative assessment for his 'Sustainability in the Food Chain', meaning a summative submission could be expected, there is no apparent progress on his Research Project. Without an approved ethics form we have to assume that either no research is being conducted, or no viable research. Not making progress on this project will likely limit his grade or lead to a non-submission. There is a concern that Harry is not engaging with this project until a self-imposed deadline has passed, such as the outcome of the OIA request or completion of his most recent SAR (which has a deadline of 14/03/2026). We are unsure of when this 'deadline' is or if this is an accurate assumption. We are aware that Harry is expressing dissatisfaction with other areas of the University. A possible outcome is interaction with a time-bound support plan, encouraging engagement in his outstanding modules. Not engaging with these may lead to an enforced Break in Study. Concerns are that not engaging with the Research Project raises the chances of him getting an unsatisfactory grade or failing his research project. The Research Project is the main area of concern, particularly if a project is completed without ethical approval. If Harry is adamant that he doesn't want Mark as a research supervisor, we could see if it is possible for another colleague to step in although we would like to understand why Harry doesn't want Mark before doing so. To help us understand, we can assign Harry a different personal tutor, who he may be willing to speak with about his research project before the School make any decisions on an alternate supervisor. Anne Coules, the module leader for the Research Project, was identified as a potential candidate to take over as Harry's personal tutor. The outcome of the meeting was agreed as: • Changing Harry's personal tutor. • Harry to meet with his new personal tutor in the next two weeks. In this meeting he can discuss his reasons for wanting to change research project supervisor. • After this meeting, there may be scope to change his supervisor.

	• If Harry does not attend the meeting nor engage with his new personal tutor, an enforced Break in Study may be in his best interests. With the action plan set, a review meeting the week commencing 23/03/2026 has been provisionally agreed. By this point Harry should have met with his new personal tutor. Progress on the actions will frame the discussion and agenda in the review meeting.
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Support to Study – Support /Action Plan – to be completed if the outcome of Stage Two meeting is a timebound action plan

This Action Plan has been developed by the Chair, Angelo Pernetta, and Support to Study Lead Steven Godby. It sets out the actions and support plan agreed during Stage Two of the Support to Study process to help the (name) to.. (add in text as appropriate e.g. improve engagement with their studies / wider University activities / support their health and wellbeing at University).

The action plan will be reviewed in a subsequent Stage 2 meeting and were the outcome of Stage Two Support to Study will be agreed.

Action Point	Agree Action / Support	Who	When
1.	Change Harry's Personal Tutor from Mark to another member of the teaching team.	Steve	By Friday 6 th March
2.	Harry to attend a tutorial with his new personal tutor.	Harry	By Friday 20 th March

Date of follow-up Stage 2 Meeting: Wednesday 25 th March 2026, time TBC
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Factors that may indicate concerns relating to the student's health and wellbeing:

See following for example only

- *E.g. Further concerns reported by students or colleagues*
- *E.g. Lack of engagement in remaining sessions*
- *E.g. Lack of engagement with mental health team*
- *E.g. Lack of progress with agreed Action Plan*

All parties are to escalate to the Support to Study Lead if these situations arise.

Distribution of notes and action plan:

The minutes and Action Plan are confirmed by the Support to Study Lead and distributed to the student within five working days of the date of this meeting. They will also be held on the student's record at the University.